Project Report: City Cleanup — Labour Day

Field	Detail
Reference	ADA/2023/003
Project Title	City Cleanup — Labour Day
Date of Activity	May 1, 2023
Location	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Implementing Organization	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Report Date	May 2023

1. Executive Summary

On May 1, 2023 (Labour Day), ADA mobilized 12 volunteers for a community environmental cleanup in Buea. The team cleared illegal dump sites along main roads, unblocked clogged drainage channels, and removed garbage from between residential buildings. The activity benefited approximately 200 community members through improved sanitation and a cleaner living environment.

2. Background & Context

This cleanup is part of ADA's annual Labour Day tradition, demonstrating the organization's commitment to community health beyond individual aid programs. Urban Buea faces ongoing sanitation challenges — illegal dumping, blocked drainage, and waste accumulation in residential areas — that directly impact public health. ADA addresses these through organized volunteer action.

3. Activities Carried Out

3.1 Preparation

- Recruited and briefed 12 volunteers
- Procured protective equipment and cleaning tools
- Arranged waste disposal truck
- Coordinated logistics (transport, refreshments)

3.2 Cleanup Operations

- **Illegal dump sites:** Cleared multiple dump sites along main roads
- **Drainage channels:** Unblocked drainage channels clogged with accumulated waste
- **Residential areas:** Removed garbage from between residential buildings
- **Waste disposal:** All collected waste transported by hired truck to proper disposal site

3.3 Team Equipment

All 12 volunteers were equipped with:

- ADA branded polo shirts (visibility and identification)
- Green caps
- Face masks (health protection)
- Red rubber gloves (safety)

- Shovels, rakes, brooms, and dustpans

4. Results & Outcomes

Outcome	Status
Streets and drainage cleaned	✅ Achieved
Illegal dump sites cleared	✅ Achieved
Waste removed from residential areas	✅ Achieved
Volunteers in full protective gear	✅ Achieved
Community health improved	✅ Achieved
Environmental awareness raised	✅ Achieved
ADA community service model demonstrated	✅ Achieved

5. Beneficiaries

- **Direct participants:** 12 ADA volunteers
- **Indirect beneficiaries:** ~200 community members benefiting from cleaner environment

6. Financial Summary

	Budgeted	Actual
Total	240,000 CFA ($400)	230,000 CFA ($383)

Savings of 10,000 CFA due to some cleaning tools already owned from the previous year's cleanup. See detailed financial report for full breakdown.

7. Challenges

- Physical intensity of manual labor in tropical heat
- Volume of waste at some dump sites exceeded initial estimates
- Some drainage channels required significant effort to unblock

8. Lessons Learned

- Annual repetition builds community expectation and support
- Branded gear increases ADA visibility and volunteer morale
- Protective equipment is essential for volunteer safety
- Retaining tools from year to year reduces costs

9. Recommendations

- Continue annual Labour Day cleanup as a signature ADA activity
- Expand volunteer numbers in future years
- Engage local authorities for sustained waste management
- Document with photos/video for awareness campaigns

10. Conclusion

The City Cleanup activity successfully achieved all planned objectives. Streets, drainage channels, and residential areas in Buea were cleaned, improving community health and sanitation. The activity reinforced ADA's reputation as a community-focused organization and raised environmental awareness among residents.

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